

The Cologne Vending Machine Business

One spray, one dollar, ninety percent margin.

What It Is

A perfume/cologne vending machine business. You install compact wall-mounted or freestanding machines that dispense a spray of designer-style fragrance for \$1–\$2 a go. People top up their scent before walking into a club, gym, date, or meeting. Each spray costs pennies, so margins are enormous, and the machine runs semi-passively.

How It Makes Money

Customers pay \$1–\$2 per spray; your cost per spray is a few cents of fragrance. You place machines in high-traffic, high-vanity locations and collect cash/card revenue with almost no labor. Buyers are gym-goers, club and bar patrons, mall shoppers, restaurant and cinema guests — anyone who wants to smell good on the spot.

Startup Costs

- Cologne vending machine (Alibaba, single or multi-scent): \$1,200–\$2,500
- Bulk fragrance oils / designer dupes to refill: \$150–\$400
- Card reader (Nayax/credit) add-on: \$200–\$400
- Location placement deal / first month's rent or revenue share: \$50–\$300
- LLC, license, signage: \$150–\$500
- Total to launch one machine: **\$1,800–\$4,000**

The Numbers

A spray uses roughly **\$0.05–\$0.15 of fragrance** and sells for **\$1–\$2**, so net margin is around **85–92% per spray**. A machine in a busy nightclub or gym can do **60–150 sprays/day** on weekends. At 90 sprays/day × \$1.50 × 90% margin = **~\$120/day**, or **\$3,000–\$4,500/month** in a strong location. Stack 3–4 machines across venues and **\$10,000–\$15,000/month** is realistic, minus refills and location fees.

How To Start

1. Buy one machine from Alibaba ("perfume vending machine") and order bulk designer-dupe fragrance oils.
2. Lock a placement deal with a busy venue — nightclub, gym, or mall — via flat rent or revenue share.
3. Add a card reader so you capture every sale and see peak-demand data.
4. Stock 2–4 popular scents (a fresh, a sweet, a designer-style) to widen appeal.
5. Brand the machine with bold signage: "Smell Great — \$1 Spray."
6. Track daily vends for 30–60 days to confirm the location performs.
7. Reinvest profits into machines 2–4 at proven high-traffic venue types.

Where To Get Customers

The location does the selling — put machines where people care how they smell and have idle moments: gym lobbies, club restrooms, mall corridors, restaurant entries, cinemas. Negotiate with venue owners by offering them a revenue share so

they actively want your machine. A bright, well-lit machine in the right hallway markets itself to everyone who passes.

Pro Tips

- **Bathroom and entry placements win.** People decide they want to smell better right before walking into a social setting — meet them there.
- **Revenue-share the venue owner.** A small cut makes the property owner your partner instead of charging you flat rent that eats margin.
- **Refill with quality dupes, not cheap junk.** A scent that actually smells designer-grade drives repeat sprays; a chemical smell kills the location.